Updated: October 14, 2026

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, Southern Methodist University 2022–2027 (Expected)
M.Sc., Economics, Federal University of Pernambuco (PIMES–UFPE), Brazil 2022
B.Sc., Economics, State University of Santa Catarina (UDESC), Brazil 2019

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Economics of Education, Health Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

Mobile Internet and the Composition of Parental Time (Job Market Paper)

Abstract: I estimate the effect of mobile internet on parents' time with their children, exploiting the staggered rollout of 3G and 4G coverage across US metropolitan areas and time diaries from the American Time Use Survey, 2004–2016. Near-universal coverage raises total childcare by 42 minutes per day, about 10 percent, with effects emerging two years after coverage arrives. Parents do not cut leisure or home production to make this time; instead, home production is unchanged in total but increasingly done with a child present. Responses are similar for mothers and fathers. Suggestive evidence indicates that more-educated parents increase active care, while less-educated parents move leisure and household tasks into their children's presence.

Low Birthweight and Child Achievement: Does Pre-K Compensate? [SSRN]

Abstract: This paper investigates whether pre-kindergarten (pre-K) attendance mediates the relationship between low birthweight and children's academic achievement in elementary school. Using the Early Childhood Longitudinal Study (ECLS-K:2011), I estimate a mediation model combining OLS with heteroskedasticity-based instrumental variables. Low birthweight exerts a persistent, negative direct effect on reading and math scores, with larger penalties in mathematics and for low-income children. The indirect effect through pre-K participation is small and statistically insignificant, indicating that pre-K does not substantially mediate the birthweight–achievement relationship nationally, though heterogeneity analyses show a positive, imprecisely estimated indirect effect for low-income children.

Changing Course: Robots and Human Capital Investment in High School (with Wookun Kim) [DRAFT]

Abstract: We study how industrial robots affect human capital investment during high school. Using Texas administrative records for 2004–2018 and an instrument based on European robot adoption, we find that greater local robot exposure shifts coursework toward college preparation and away from vocational subjects. We also document lower dropout and higher observed completion. Advanced course enrollment rises throughout high school, while dropout reductions and additional math, science, and technology coursework are concentrated in the upper grades. Both boys and girls increase academic investment, but the implications for gender gaps differ: some differences in subject enrollment narrow, while girls' larger gains in advanced coursework reinforce their existing advantage. These patterns suggest that students respond to changing local labor demand by strengthening their preparation for further education. Human capital formation is therefore an early margin of adjustment to automation, shaping the skills of the workforce that will face its longer-run consequences.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Impact of Pre-K on Socioemotional and Cognitive Skills

PUBLICATIONS

"Wage Profile and Gender Gap in Science and Technology: Regional Disparities in Brazil" (with Patricia Bonini and Gabriela Sótero). *Sociedad y Economía,* 2025.

"Força de Trabalho em Ciência e Tecnologia: Santa Catarina no Contexto Brasileiro" (with Patricia Bonini and Carolina Fernandes Custódio). *Cadernos de Gênero e Tecnologia*, 2022.

"Formação e Atuação Profissional nas Áreas STEM no Brasil: Ainda Temos Pouco?" (with Patricia Bonini, Gabriel Okawati, and Carolina Fernandes Custódio). *Atena Editora,* 2020.

"Convergence Analysis of Per Capita Income in Municipalities in the South Region of Brazil between 1999 and 2014" (with Lucas Garcia Dos Santos and Adriano Amarante). *Revista Brasileira de Gestão e Desenvolvimento Regional*, 2020.

HONORS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Selected Participant, CSWEP Mentoring Workshop for PhD Students, Southern Economic Association — 2026

Graduate Student Summer Research and Writing Fellowship, Dedman College Interdisciplinary Institute, SMU — 2026

Provost's Summer Research Grant, SMU — 2025

Graduate Assistantship, SMU — 2022–2027

FACEPE Fellowship (Master's) — 2020–2022

Best Undergraduate Thesis in Economic Science, Regional Council of Economy of Santa Catarina — 2020

PRESENTATIONS

2026

- International Conference on Empirical Economics
- North Texas Economics Conference *[scheduled]*
- Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting *[scheduled]*
- SMU Economics Brown Bag Seminar *[scheduled]*

2025

- Stata Texas Empirical Microeconomics Conference
- SMU Graduate Poster Session

2019

- ANPEC Sul
- Associação de Pesquisadores em Economia Catarinense (APEC)
- Seminário de Iniciação Científica, UDESC

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Southern Methodist University

Lecturer, Intermediate Microeconomics — Fall 2026
Lead Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics & Macroeconomics — 2023–2026
Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics — 2022–2023

Federal University of Pernambuco
Teaching Assistant, Statistics I — 2021–2022

State University of Santa Catarina
Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Methods in Economics I & II — 2018–2019

SERVICE

Referee Service
International Journal of Manpower, Journal of Fair Trade

University Service
First-Year Graduate Student Mentor, Department of Economics, SMU — 2023–2025
Judge, Undergraduate Research Poster Session, SMU — Spring 2026

SKILLS

Software: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX
Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent)